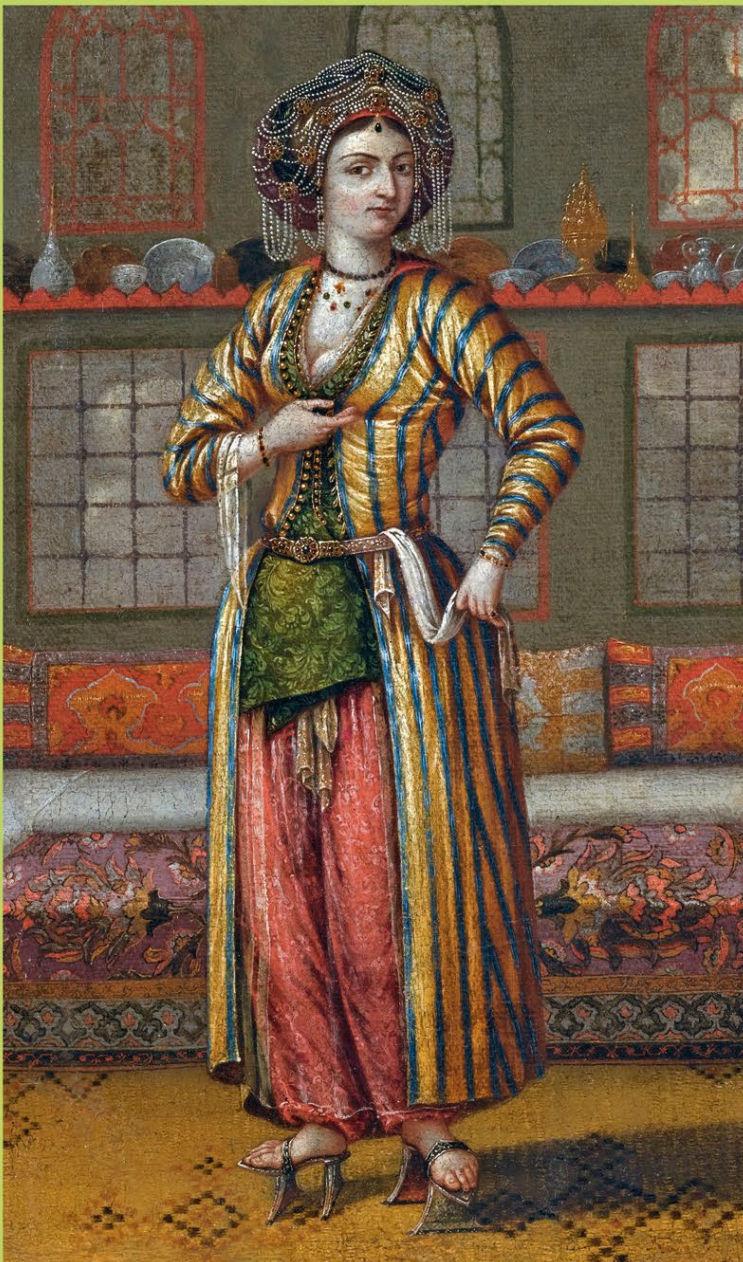


THROUGH THE AGES

Fashion

What women wear affects how they are perceived and signifies their status. Fashion is constantly evolving and reflects women's changing lives—from trousers in the 1920s to the choice of black in support of the #MeToo campaign at the Golden Globes in 2018.



► **If the shoe fits**

Hammam clogs, like the ones worn by this noble lady in 18th-century Constantinople (modern Istanbul), were worn by women at Turkish baths to avoid dirty water on the floor. The shoes' height also indicated their social status.

“**Fashion is part of the daily air and it changes ... with all the events.**”

DIANA VREELAND, NOTED
COLUMNIST AND FASHION EDITOR, 1978

SINCE ANTIQUITY people have expressed their identity through dress. Although historians disagree on the starting point of Western fashion, the desire to dress up was accelerated in the 15th century as Europe grew more prosperous and imported textiles became signifiers of wealth. The urban elite set the styles, which were then adopted by the growing middle class in simpler forms. Fashion also evolved in response to the environments in which women lived. For example, in 16th-century Venice women wore shoes on tall stilts (chopines) to avoid the mud. By the 17th century, the most popular fashions came from France, where women wore lace, silk, and brocade. Dressmakers across the Western world adopted their styles with the help of engravings of the French designs.

Almost all women's clothing before the 19th century was made-to-measure. Wealthy women had garments made for them by couturiers, while working women, made their